Participant Profile Form

MSCA Staff Exchanges 2027 (MSCA-SE 2027) — consortium-building process

Unidad de Excelencia IOBA | University of Valladolid

Purpose:
This form is intended to collect structured information from interested participants for the preparation of an MSCA Staff Exchanges consortium. It is designed to support both (i) later completion of participant-related information requested in the EU Funding & Tenders Portal, and (ii) the creation of an internal profile database to help identify complementarities and facilitate contacts across the emerging consortium.

Please complete one form per:

- non-academic organisation (SMEs, NGOs , patient organisations)
- participating academic team (one form per PI, research-group, department).

This prospective **MSCA Staff Exchanges 2027 consortium** aims to build an international, interdisciplinary and inter-sectoral network in eye and vision research, centred on translational collaboration and staff mobility. Starting from Unidad de Excelencia IOBA's strengths in advanced therapies, biomarkers, inflammation, neuroprotection and health technology assessment, the network remains open to additional interdisciplinary collaborations, including areas such as ocular surface, retina, inherited and age-related eye disease, neuro-vision, optometry, drug delivery, AI-enabled diagnosis and patient-oriented validation, while remaining fully open to any other complementary expertise that could enrich the consortium and strengthen its patient-focused impact.

Important:
- please use this form to capture your general interests, expertise, and rough capacity to send and/or host staff.
- If you are not sure how to answer any field, you may leave it blank and highlight it.

1. Organisation and administrative profile

Organisation legal name	Universidad de Valladolid
Short name / acronym used in projects	UVA
Participant Identification Code (PIC)	999862809
Website(s)	www.ioba.es
Country	Spain
Organisation type	X Academic ☐ Non-academic ☐ Hospital / clinic ☐ SME ☐ Large company ☐ Research infrastructure ☐ NGO / foundation ☐ Public body ☐ Other
Main address	Paseo de Belén 17, 47011, Valladolid, España
Department(s), institute(s), research group(s) or unit(s) that would be involved	Nanotechnological Solutions for Ocular Functional Recovery (NANO-SOS-4EYE)
Additional institutional resources relevant to collaboration	

Main contact person for this profile	Yolanda Diebold, PhD, Full Professor Ophthalmology, University of Valladolid
Main contact email	yolanda.diebold@uva.es
Other contact person(s), if relevant	Laura García-Posadas, PhD, laura.gacia.posadas@uva.es

2. Scientific / innovation profile and relevance for an IOBA-led consortium

Please describe your profile at the level of the participating team / unit most relevant to the prospective consortium.

Indicative thematic relevance (tick all that apply)	
X Ocular surface	☐ Retina
☐ Inherited retinal dystrophies (IRDs)	☐ Age-related ocular disease
☐ Neuro-vision / integrated vision / neuro-ophthalmology	☐ Optometry / visual behaviour / rehabilitation
X Advanced therapies / regenerative medicine	X Gene therapy / cell therapy / tissue engineering
X Inflammation / biomarkers / neuroprotection	X Drug delivery / formulations / nanomedicine
X Drug discovery / screening / repurposing	☐ Ocular vascular disease
☐ Infection / trauma-related ocular disease	☐ Ocular pain / quality of life / patient-reported outcomes
☐ Health technology assessment	☐ AI-assisted diagnosis / software / digital tools
☐ Clinical trials / translational validation	☐ Other (please specify):

Free Keywords for internal searchable database (please provide up to 10)	conjunctiva; cornea; drug delivery; extracellular vesicles; ocular surface inflammation; oxidative stress; regeneration; secretome; tissue engineering
Geographies of interest for exchanges (optional)	

Overview of your research / innovation focus
Our focus is therapeutic innovation to treat ocular surface inflammatory diseases. In one hand, we use nanotechnology to design novel anti-inflammatory and immunomodulatory nanomedicines. On the other hand, we develop more complex and compliant with the 3Rs in vitro and ex vivo models in which our therapeutical developments can be reliably tested. Currently, our work is focused on the development of 3D models of human cornea and conjunctiva, the study of the therapeutic potential of cornea and conjunctiva-derived extracellular vesicles (EVs), and the design of novel drug delivery platforms combining new generation nanoparticles and EVs.

Why your team could be relevant to a translational eye-health and vision consortium
Our team would bring to such a consortium our expertise in testing the potential of active molecules and/or novel nanomedicines in relevant human-derived 2D and 3D in vitro models, and in ex vivo porcine and rabbit eye models. Also, our know-how about ocular surface tissue-derived EVs in terms of isolation, enrichment, characterization and functional assays. Finally, we have knowledge and resources to develop nanomedicines using drug delivery platforms and tissue engineering strategies combining cells and different biomaterials.

3. Expertise, assets and collaboration interests

Core expertise, methods and platforms you could contribute
• *Cell culture (2D, 3D, primary cells, immortalized cell lines, mesenchymal stromal cells)* • *ELISA, WB analysis, Multiplex analysis, Q-PCR, immunofluorescent staining, histopathology, Confocal and AFM microscopies, DLS* • *In vitro models for human cornea and conjunctiva (normal, inflamed, under oxidative stress wound healing)* • *Ex vivo ocular surface models from rabbit and pig enucleated eyes*

Infrastructure, equipment, facilities or datasets relevant to consortium work
• *In-house specialized laboratories for cell culture, histopathology, protein and genetic material analyses; access to Laboratorio de Técnicas Instrumentales from the University of Valladolid*

- *Access to ocular surface human tissues*
- *Access to enucleated rabbit and pig eyes from a certified slaughterhouse*

Training capacity and knowledge-transfer potential
• *Scientific, technical, and translational skills* • *Soft skills*

What your team would hope to gain from participating
Access to methods and technologies, patient-oriented validation, joint publications and longer-term strategic collaboration.

4. Key people likely to be involved

Please list the key people who may be relevant to the consortium at this stage. *This is not a final, binding or secondment list.*

Name	Position / role	Department / unit	Staff category	Career stage	Email / identifier (optional)
Yolanda Diebold	PI	IOBA-UVa / NANO-SOS-4EYE	Full Professor	Senior (R4)	yolanda.diebold@uva.es
Laura García-Posadas	Co-PI	IOBA-UVa / NANO-SOS-4EYE	Associate Professor	Senior (R3)	laura.garcia.posadas@uva.es
Marta Mínguez-Moratinos	Predoctoral student	IOBA-UVa / NANO-SOS-4EYE	Predoctoral student	Early (R1)	
Guillermo López-Salmerón	Predoctoral student	IOBA-UVa / NANO-SOS-4EYE	Predoctoral student	Early (R1)	

Main disciplines represented in your team	Cell biology, immunology, biotechnology, biomaterials, pharmaceutical technology
Experience in EU / international / multi-partner collaborative projects	The PI has previous experience in 3 EU collaborative projects and in a bilateral Germany-Spain collaborative project. The Co-PI has experience in 1 EU collaborative project, in a bilateral Germany-Spain collaborative project, and in 3 USA projects (NIH grants)
Experience with clinical, translational or patient-facing research (if relevant)	☐ Yes X No ☐ Not applicable | Short note:

5. Evidence of capacity and track record

Up to 5 relevant publications / datasets / software / products / services / other achievements
1) Krstić L, Vallejo R, Rodriguez-Rojo S, González-García MJ, Arias FJ, Girotti A, Diebold Y. Effective ocular delivery of antioxidant polyphenols using elastin-like polymer nanosystems developed by sustainable process. Int J Pharm. 2025 Jun 10;678:125691. doi: 10.1016/j.ijpharm.2025.125691. *Impact Factor = 5.2; Position Journal/Field: 43/352 Pharmacology & Pharmacy (Q1)* *2) Diebold Y, García-Posadas L. Ex vivo applications of porcine ocular surface tissues: Advancing eye research and alternatives to animal studies. Histol Histopathol. 2025 Aug;40(8):1139-1151. doi: 10.14670/HH-18-873.* *Impact Factor = 2; Position Journal/Field: 45/90 Pathology (Q2)* *3) Romero-Castillo I, López-García A, Diebold Y, García-Posadas L. Enrichment protocols for human conjunctival extracellular vesicles and their characterization. Sci Rep. 2024 Nov 16;14(1):28270. doi: 10.1038/s41598-024-79481-1.* *Impact Factor = 3.9; Position Journal/Field: 25/136 Multidisciplinary Science (Q1)*

4) García-Posadas L, Romero-Castillo I, Brennan K, Mc Gee MM, Blanco-Fernández A, Diebold Y. Isolation and Characterization of Human Conjunctival Mesenchymal Stromal Cells and Their Extracellular Vesicles. Invest Ophthalmol Vis Sci. 2023 Sep 1;64(12):38. doi: 10.1167/iovs.64.12.38.
Impact Factor = 4.4; Position Journal/Field: 7/62 Ophthalmology (Q1)
5) Diebold Y, García-Posadas L. Is the Conjunctiva a Potential Target for Advanced Therapy Medicinal Products? Pharmaceutics. 2021 Jul 26;13(8):1140. doi: 10.3390/pharmaceutics13081140.
Impact Factor = 6.525; Position Journal/Field: 39/279 Pharmacology & Pharmacy (Q1)

Up to 5 relevant previous projects, grants, networks or collaborations
Only projects in which I was local PI and/or coordinator: 1. *Tailoring nanoparticle-extracellular vesicle association as therapeutic platform for selective ocular surface tissue targeting (NANOSEVs). Ministry of Science and Innovation, PID2023-148252OB-C21 (Coordinated), National with international collaborators (225,000€), 2024/2028.* 2. *Human conjunctival 3D model for investigating the ocular effects of biological therapy (3D-Conj-OSD). Private international project (164,884€), 2024-2027.* 3. *Ocular topical administration of sorbitan ester nanoparticles for intraocular neuroprotection (RETINARTEX). Ministry of Science and Innovation, PDC2022-133239-C21 (Coordinated), National (115,000€), 2022/2024.* 4. *Delivery of artificial exosomes to treat blinding eye diseases (ARTEX4EYE). Ministry of Science, Innovation and University, RTI2018-094071-B-C21 (Coordinated), National with international collaborators (217,800€), 2019/2022.* 5. *Drug Discovery and Delivery NEtwork for ONcology and Eye Therapeutics (3D NEONET). H2020-MSCA-RISE-2016, Grant Agreement nº. 734907, International (945,000€ (UVA 37.600€)), 2017/2022.* 6. *Drug Discovery and Development of Novel Eye Therapeutics (3D-NET). FP7-PEOPLE-2013-IAPP, Marie Curie Industry-Academia Pathways and Partnerships (IAPP) action, Grant Agreement nº. 612218, Internacional (1,663,674€ (UVA 34,967.12€)), 2013/2017.*

Patents, protected know-how, clinical protocols, validated tools or other translational assets (if any)

6. Staff-exchange capacity (only rough estimation at this stage)

Please provide only a rough, non-binding estimate of your organisation's/team's capacity to send and/or host staff **over the 48-month duration of the project.**

Could your organisation/team second staff?	X Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No capacity to send staff on secondment
Could your organisation second staff categories beyond researchers (where relevant to R&I activities)?	X Only Researchers X Technical Staff/Innovation ☐ Managerial / project support ☐ Admin Staff ☐ Other profiles
Could your organisation host incoming staff from academic and/or non-academic sectors?	☐ Academic only ☐ Non-academic only X Both ☐ No capacity to host
Administrative / HR / legal considerations that may affect mobility	

7. Matchmaking information: Summary for the internal participant database

Capabilities you would most like other interested participants to notice
• *Experience in isolating, characterizing and functional studies of ocular surface cell-derived extracellular vesicles (only team in IOBA-UVa with such a strength).* • *Strong know-how in 3Rs compliant in vitro and ex vivo models to study ocular surface pathophysiology.* • *Experience with diverse nanotechnological platforms to develop ocular surface nanomedicines.*

Capabilities or expertise you would especially like to access through the consortium
• *Biomaterial experts and methods to improve our engineered 3D models of ocular surface structures.* • *Translational pathways to achieve extracellular vesicle-based therapies.* • *Expertise in different drug delivery-based approaches to develop regenerative and/or antiinflammatoy nanomedicines.*

Please Confirm:

Open to being contacted by other interested participants through the coordination team's mediation?	X Yes ☐ No
X We understand that the information contained in this form will be searchable and accessible to other interested participants within the pre-consortium process.	

8. Final remarks and query items

Please note any uncertainties, prerequisites, internal approvals needed, or items that should be considered further before the consortium is consolidated.

Internal use and confidentiality statement

The information provided in this form will be used only for internal consortium-building purposes in connection with the preparation of a prospective MSCA Staff Exchanges proposal (2027 call) coordinated from Unidad de Excelencia IOBA / University of Valladolid. It may be used by the coordination team to: (i) assess strategic fit and administrative readiness, (ii) prepare participant-related information required at proposal stage, and (iii) build an internal profile database to facilitate contacts among interested participants. The information will not be shared outside this pre-consortium context without prior permission from the contributing organisation / contact person, except where later required for the formal preparation of a proposal with the explicit involvement of that organisation. Submission of this form confirms that the contributor agrees to this internal use. Organisations may request correction, update or withdrawal of their information at any time by contacting the coordination team.

X **Understood**

Name: Yolanda Diebold
Date completed: 22 May, 2026

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